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Peals & Quarter Peals

5,040 changes *and onwards*

Peals are the gold standard of change ringing — over five thousand sequences, rung continuously without aids, taking the better part of three hours on these bells. Quarter peals are 1,260 changes. Both have a long history at St Peter's.

Peals

What a peal is

The Central Council of Church Bell Ringers details the conditions required for a peal. Peals rung on five, six or seven working bells must consist of at least 5,040 changes; for eight or more working bells a peal must comprise a minimum of 5,000 changes. Each bell must be rung continuously by the same person without a break, and the ringing must be done entirely from memory. Peals may be rung to commemorate special occasions and events.

To date, **138 peals** have been rung at St Peter's, Great Totham. The first peal was rung on 26th October 1895 by a band from Coggeshall; on 6th May 1899 the first peal was rung by members of the Great Totham band itself. The most recent peal was rung on 2nd November 2014 by six Essex Association ringers — seven Minor Methods, in remembrance of Able Seaman Charles Henry Ballard, the first Essex ringer to fall on 1st November 1914 while serving on HMS *Monmouth*. He was a loyal ringer at St Peter's.

The [Felstead Database](#) records all peals rung but does not include details of the ringers or the occasion.

Peal Boards

The boards in the ringing chamber

Ten peal boards hang in the ringing chamber at St Peter's, painted by hand and recording specific peals. Click any board below to see it full-size.

ESSEX ASSOCIATION OF CHANGE RINGERS.

On Saturday Oct 26th 1895 the
Coddeshall Ringers rang on
these Bells 5040 Changes of
Minor, in 2^h 45^m in the fol-
lowing Methods, being the
first Peal on these Bells.

WOODBINE, NEW LONDON, KENT,
OXFORD, DOUBLE COURT, YORK-
SHIRE COURT, AND BOB MINOR.

RICHARD POTTER.	TREBLE.
WILLIAM DYER.	2.
CHARLES NORFOLK.	3.
JOHN SADLER.	4.
ERNEST W BECKWITH.	5.
DAVID H ELLIOTT.	TENOR.



[26th October 1895](#)

[The first peal at St Peter's](#)

THE
 ESSEX ASSOCIATION
 OF CHANCERINGERS

On Saturday May 6th 1899, in
3^{HRS} 6^{MINS} was rung on these Bells
a PEAL of MINOR, 5,040 Changes
being three 720^s of BOB MINOR
two of CANTERBURY PLEASURE,
one each of GRANDSIRE & COLLEGE SING

 WILLIAM TROWLES. TREBLE
 HENRY C ROWE. 2.
 HARRY BROWN. 3.
 SAMUEL RUSHEN. 4.
 JOSEPH SEACER. 5.
 THOMAS HAMMOND. TENOR
Conducted by T. H. H. H.



[6th May 1899](#)

[First peal by St Peter's ringers](#)

GREAT TOTHAM ESSEX

The Essex Association.

On Sunday February 3rd 1901.
in two hours & forty seven minutes.

A PEAL OF BOB MINOR.

5040 Changes.

*Being seven T20's, each called differently
was rung on these bells by the following
ringers.*

PERCY SAYER	Treble.
HARRY SEAGER	2
HARRY BROWN	3
SAMUEL RUSHEN	4
CHARLES BALLARD	5
THOMAS HAMMOND	Tenor.

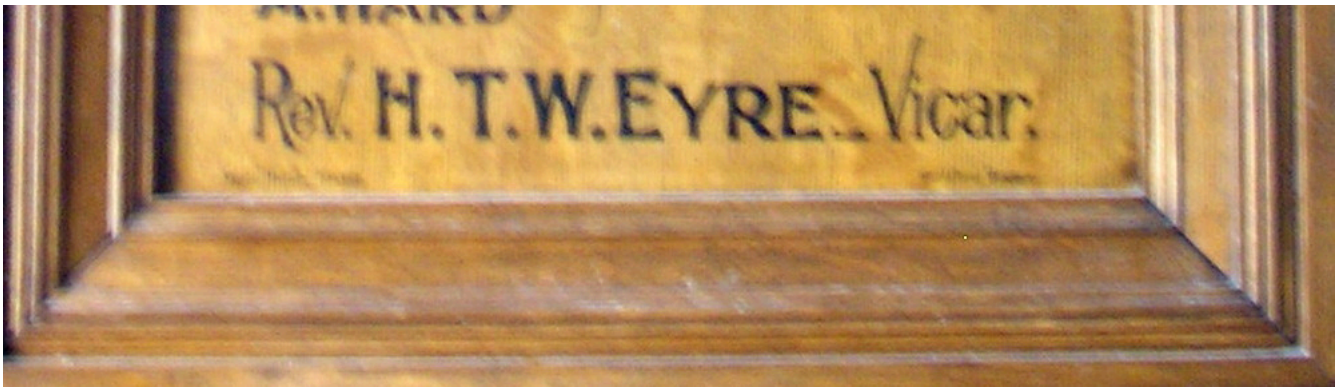
Conducted by T. HAMMOND.

Rung with the bells deeply muffled
as a last token of respect to

OUR LATE MAJESTY LADY QUEEN VICTORIA.

M. GOTTEE
A. WARD

Churchwardens.



[3rd February 1901](#)
[For the death of Queen Victoria](#)

GREAT TOTHAM ESS
 The Essex Association
 On Thursday August 24th
 in 2 hours & 45 minutes at
 Church of ST PETER, a peal of M
 5040 changes, being 720 ea
 Canterbury Pleasure, College Sir
 Kent Treble Bob, Grandsi
 Oxford Bob, Oxford Treble Bob & Pl
 ERNEST C. LAMBERT, TR
 * THOMAS HAMMOND,
 * HARRY BROWN, "
 PERCY SAYER, "
 FRED CHALK, "
 JOHN D. BUCKINGHAM, T
Conducted by Ernest C. Lamb
 * First peal in seven metho
Rung as a Birthday Compliment to the Con
 REV. H. T. W. EYRE, VICA
 M. COTTEE, Churchward



[24th August 1905](#)

[For the conductor's birthday.](#)

GREAT TOTHAM ESSEX.

The Essex Association.

TUESDAY OCT: 31ST 1933

In two hours & fifty six minutes

A PEAL OF MINOR 5040 CHANGES

WAS RUNG ON THESE BELLS

BEING *720 College Exercise*

720 Double Court

two 720 Kent Treble Bob

two 720 Oxford Treble Bob

720 Bob Minor

H. E. SEAGER Treble

V. W. MILLS 2ND

F. W. SHYNN 3RD

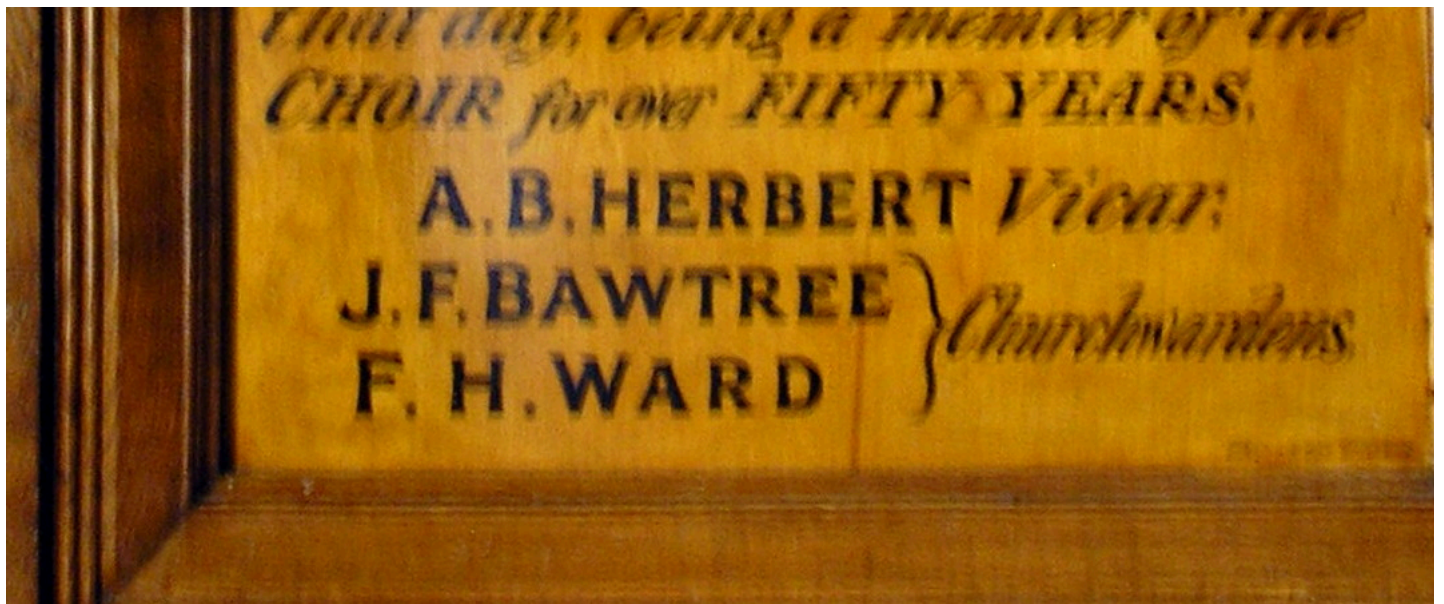
E. J. SHYNN 4TH

J. E. SEAGER 5TH

P. C. SAYER Tenor.

CONDUCTED BY P. C. SAYER.

*Rung with the Bells half muffled
as a token of respect to the late
M^{RS} A. BROCKIS, who was laid to rest*



[31st October 1933](#)

[In memory of Mr A. Brockis](#)

GT TOTHAM B

Essex Association

MONDAY JAN: 27TH 193

A PEAL MINOR 5.040 CHAN

—*In 3 Hours*—

Being 720 Cambridge Surpr

1440 Kent Treble Bob.

720 Double Court.

1440 Oxford Treble Bob.

720 College Exercise.

H. E. SEAGER, TREBLE

G. W. BARBER, 2ND

F. W. SHYNN, 3RD

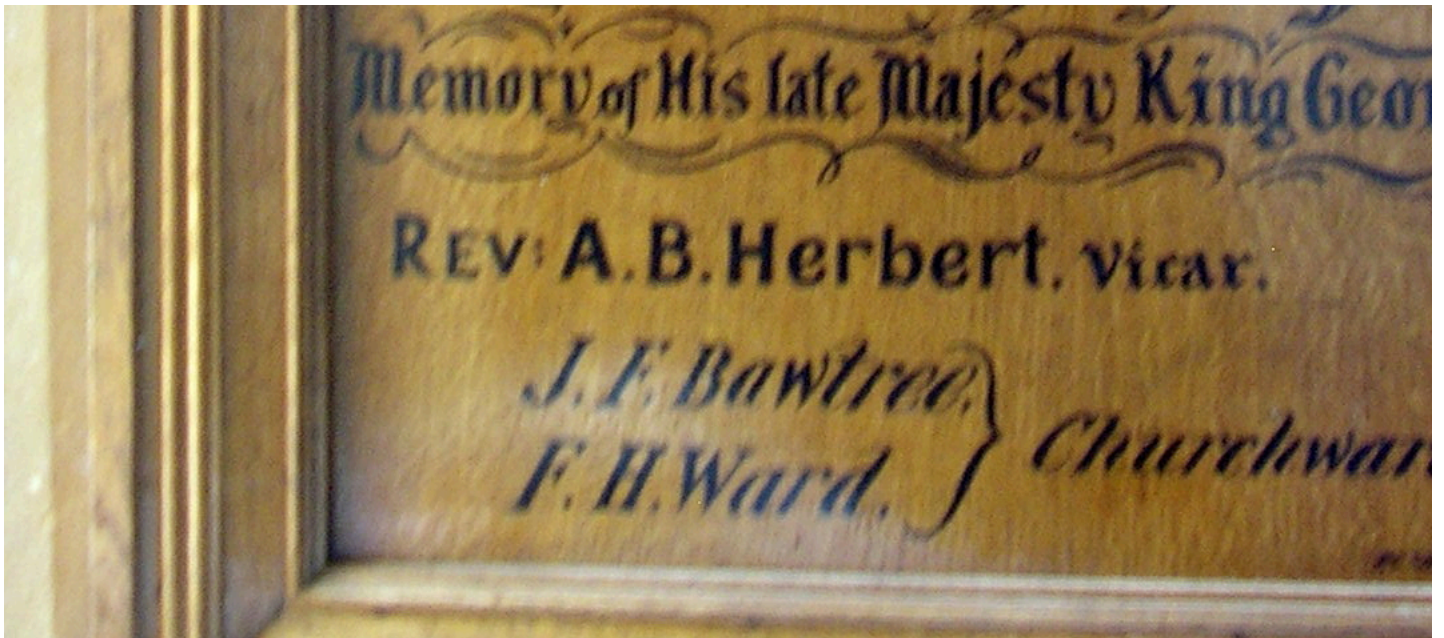
V. W. MILLS, 4TH

E. J. SHYNN, 5TH

P. C. SAYER, TENOR

Conducted by P. C. S.

Rung with the Bells fully muffled



[27th January 1936](#)

[For the death of King George V](#)

GT. TOTHAM

The Essex Association

ON SAT. FEBRUARY 9TH 1952
A PEAL OF 5,040 MINOR
IN 3 HOURS

Being

720 *Double Court*
1440 *Plain Bob*
1440 *Kent Treble Bob*
1440 *Oxford Treble Bob*

P. J. CAME	Treble
J. E. G. ROAST	2 nd
H. E. SEAGER	3 rd
J. WEST	4 th
G. BARBER	5 th
E. J. SHYNN	Tenor

CONDUCTED BY E. J. SHYNN

*Rung with the bells half muffled
as a last token of respect to*

His Late Majesty

KING GEORGE VI



[9th February 1952](#)

[For the death of King George VI](#)

GREAT TOTHAM ESSEX

ST. PETER

The Essex Association

ON SUNDAY 24TH JUNE, 1990
IN 2 HOURS AND 27 MINUTES.

A PEAL OF SPLICED SURPRISE MINOR

5040 CHANGES

*In 14 Methods (i) Ipswich, Norfolk (ii) Cambridge,
Primrose, (iii) Bourne, Netherscote; (iv) Chester,
Munden; (v) London, Wells; (vi) York, Durham,
(vii) Beverley, Salford.*

MICHAEL J. EDWARDS	TREBLE
YVONNE A. TOWLER	2
ADRIAN C. MALTON	3
EDWIN PARSONS	4
PATRICK W. SALTMARSH	5
JAMES L. TOWLER	TENOR

Conducted by Adrian C. Malton

*Arranged and rung to mark the Ordination
to the Priesthood of the Rev. Peter William Youde
earlier this day at Saffron Walden to serve
in the Parish of Great Totham.*



[24th January 1990](#)

[Ordination of Rev. Peter William Youle](#)

GREAT TOTHAM ESSEX

ST. PETER

The Essex Association

ON FRIDAY 4th AUGUST 2000

IN 2 HOURS AND 37 MINUTES

A PEAL OF SPLICED SURPRISE MINOR

5040 CHANGES

*In 16 Methods (i) Cambridge, Norfolk, Ipswich
Hull, Primrose, Bourne. (ii) Chester, Mordon
(iii) London, Wells. (iv) York, Durham. (v) Westminster,
Allendale. (vi) Beverly, Surfleet.
(vii) Ipswich, Cambridge.*

Mary Roast	Treble
Janice S. Spalding	2
Edwin Parsons	3
Patrick W. Saltmarsh	4
Tony Spurgeon	5
Joe E.G. Roast	Tenor

Conducted by Joe E.G. Roast

*Arranged and Rung as a 100th Birthday Compliment
to Her Majesty Queen Elizabeth, The Queen Mother.*

Robert Tarpey

Churchwardens

Robert Lewis



[4th August 2000](#)

[100th birthday of HM Queen Elizabeth the Queen Mother](#)

GREAT TOTHAM ESSEX
ST. PETER

The Essex Association

SATURDAY 15th SEPTEMBER 2012
IN 2 HOURS AND 35 MINUTES
A PEAL OF SURPRISE MINOR

5040 CHANGES

*In 7 Methods: London, York, Bourne,
Ipswich, Beverly, Surfleet and Cambridge.*

Andrew P. Brewster	Treble
Christina D.A. Brewster	2
Janice S. Spalding	3
James L. Towler	4
Yvonne A. Towler	5
Colin F. Chapman	Tenor

Conducted by Colin F. Chapman



[15th September 2012](#)
[Diamond Jubilee of HM Queen Elizabeth II](#)

In a picture frame on the coat hooks

Four peals and a date touch, 1905 – 1912

Recorded on cards rather than peal boards. Of particular note is the peal rung on **16th April 1912** — the first peal of Treble Bob on these bells. 5,040 changes, in 2 hours and 42 minutes.

[Read the full details \(PDF\) →](#)

Quarter Peals

1,260 changes, around forty minutes

A quarter peal at St Peter's typically takes around 40 minutes. They are rung for special occasions, to mark the progress of a ringer, and for enjoyment. The records below cover quarter peals rung at St Peter's since 2013 with at least one Great Totham ringer in the band — together with details of the bells rung for other significant occasions. Each opens as a PDF.

- [24th March 2013PDF](#)
- [4th August 2014PDF](#)
- [7th December 2014PDF](#)
- [8th February 2015PDF](#)
- [8th March 2015PDF](#)
- [21st April 2015PDF](#)
- [1st May 2015PDF](#)
- [6th September 2015PDF](#)
- [24th November 2015PDF](#)
- [29th November 2015PDF](#)
- [26th April 2016PDF](#)
- [17th July 2016PDF](#)
- [26th March 2017PDF](#)
- [2nd April 2017PDF](#)
- [7th May 2017PDF](#)
- [Call Changes — 19th May 2018PDF](#)
- [14th October 2018PDF](#)
- [Call Changes — 11th November 2018PDF](#)
- [Rounds — 11th November 2018PDF](#)
- [20th January 2019PDF](#)
- [3rd March 2019PDF](#)
- [28th July 2019PDF](#)
- [3rd March 2022PDF](#)
- [5th September 2022PDF](#)

St Peter's, Great Totham

Bell ringers of St Peter's Church, Great Totham, Essex. Members of the Essex Association of Change Ringers, Maldon & District Guild.

Visit

- Church Road

- Great Totham
- Essex CM9 8NP
- [A Church Near You](#) ↗

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